

THE CONSTRAINT SOLUTION FRAMEWORK

A practical roadmap for solving your real constraint
and building momentum at the same time.

For quiz-takers whose result is
"You Have a Real Constraint."

CHI-CHI | IDEAL CLARITY

So yours came back as a real constraint.

Good — that's actually useful information.

Most people who take the Facts-or-Fear assessment discover their “reasons” are fear in disguise. Yours aren't — or at least, not entirely. You have something real in the way: money, time, a contract, a caregiving load, a health situation, a genuine skill gap.

Here's what I want you to hear: **a real constraint is a design input, not a stop sign.** It tells you *how* to build — not *whether* to build. The only thing it can't do is think for you. That's what this framework is for.

Step 1: Name it precisely.

Vague constraints run your life. Specific ones become a spec sheet.

Vague: “I don't have time.” → **Precise:** “I have 45 minutes a day, 6:00–6:45am, before the house wakes up.”

Vague: “I don't have the money.” → **Precise:** “I can invest \$200/month without touching savings.”

Vague: “My job won't allow it.” → **Precise:** “My non-compete covers X for 12 months; it doesn't cover Y.”

Write yours down in one sentence with a **number** in it. If there's no number, it's not precise yet.

Step 2: Test it — permanent or seasonal?

Ask: *“If this constraint lifted in 90 days, what would I start preparing right now?”*

If you have an answer, the constraint is **seasonal**. It's real, but it expires. Your job is to use the waiting period for **preparation, not postponement**.

If you genuinely can't picture it lifting, it's **structural**. Your job is to design the smallest version of the thing that fits inside it permanently.

Most constraints people call “permanent” are seasonal. And seasonal constraints still need a plan — otherwise they quietly become permanent.

Step 3: Design around it — three moves.

Shrink.

Make the first step so small the constraint can't block it. Can't afford a launch? You can afford one conversation with one potential customer. No time for a business? You have time for one page of the book.

Sequence.

Ask what can happen *before* the constraint lifts. Research, relationships, audience-building, skill-stacking — most of the real work of starting doesn't require the constraint to be gone first.

Schedule.

Put a date on it. When does the non-compete end? When do the kids' schedules change? When will you revisit this? A constraint with a review date is a plan. One without is a story.

Step 4: The 90-day audit.

Constraints expire. Fear doesn't. Every 90 days, re-run Step 2. The day your answers change and you *still* don't move — that's the day you'll know it stopped being about the constraint.

A real constraint tells you **how** to build.

Fear tells you **whether** to build.

Don't confuse the two — and don't let a real constraint become fear's favorite hiding place.

If you're not sure which one you're dealing with anymore, that's exactly what the Next Chapter Conversation is for: 45 minutes, you and me, naming what's actually in the way.

Book Your FREE Next Chapter Conversation

idealclarity.com/next-chapter

— Chi-Chi